

I Want to Know What Love Is -- Foreigner

Bass: Harley Benton P/J, 5-string, passive. Full board.

1984 AOR power ballad (*Agent Provocateur*). ~67 BPM (estimate -- no hard chart reference, tempo isn't load-bearing for the tone choices below). Textbook quiet-verse-to-massive-choir-chorus structure -- piano and vocal carry the verses almost alone, and the chorus detonates into full band plus gospel choir. The bass job is to stay warm, simple, and out of the way in the verses, then lean in for the chorus lift without ever getting aggressive -- this is a ballad, not a rock song, even at its biggest.

AMP: Mess Bass (Mesa/Boogie Bass 400) + CAB: EBS410 IR (User IR 4)

Rebuilt 2026-09-18 off the GP-5's own AMP + a loaded IR -- NAMs are off for now (Valeton N->S volume issue, device-side). The old NAM was a Darkglass B7K Ultra dialed low-gain rather than driven, chosen at the time for its flexible independent Gain/Bass/Middle/Treble tone-shaping. Mess Bass at the same low gain gives the same warm, present clean target; EBS410 is ir.md's own pick for clean bass tones.

GP-5 Settings

Module order: NR -> PRE -> DST -> AMP -> CAB -> EQ -> MOD -> DLY -> RVB

NR -- Gate

- THRE: 18
- Always on. Low-gain, clean patch -- just enough to clean up idle noise, nothing more aggressive needed.

PRE -- Micro Boost (MXR M133 Micro Amp)

- Gain: 48
- **CTL switch.** Off = bypassed, On = engaged.
- Same mechanism as the site's other verse/chorus worship-ballad patches: a simple, clean volume/presence lift, no tone coloring. Off (verse) stays intimate, sitting under the piano. On (chorus) pushes the part forward enough to sit with the choir and full band, without turning into a different tone.

DST -- Off

Not used. No drive anywhere in this tone -- the amp stays clean regardless of CTL state.

AMP -- Mess Bass, always on.

- Gain: 28 -- kept low, a clean tone, not a driven one.
- VOL: 65
- Bass: 58 -- warmth and low-end weight this song's big chorus wants.
- Middle: 55, Treble: 55 -- both moderate, present without being aggressive or scooped.

CAB -- User IR 4 (EBS410), always on. VOL 58.

EQ -- Bass EQ 1

- 33Hz: +4, 150Hz: +1, 600Hz: -2, 2kHz: +3, 8kHz: +1, VOL: 52

- Always on, both CTL states. Gentle low-end weight for the ballad's foundation, a small 600Hz dip to avoid boxiness, a modest 2kHz push for note definition under the choir. Nothing aggressive -- this whole patch stays warm and unforced.

MOD -- B-Chorus (Boss CE-2B for Bass)

- Depth: 15, Rate: 0.4Hz, VOL: 50
- Always on, both states. Light touch, per the usual rule -- just enough shimmer to give it that 80s ballad width, not an obvious effect.

DLY -- Off

Not used. Space in this patch comes from the reverb, not repeats.

RVB -- Hall

- Mix: 33, Decay: 58, Trail: On
- **CTL switch.** Off = bypassed, On = engaged.
- Off (verse) stays dry and close -- the piano and vocal lead, bass stays out of the way. On (chorus) adds a big, lush hall swell to match the choir/full-band payoff -- one of the biggest chorus moments in the genre deserves a genuinely big reverb lift, not a token one.

CTL Summary (GP-5)

- **CTL Off -- Verse (default load state):** Micro Boost and Hall both bypassed. Warm, simple, intimate -- supports the piano/vocal without competing.
- **CTL On -- Chorus:** Micro Boost and Hall both engaged. A gentle push plus a big reverb swell -- opens the part up for the choir/full-band chorus without changing the fundamental tone.

Full Pedalboard

Signal chain order: Flamma FS-08 Octave -> Donner Ultimate Comp -> Donner Stylish Fuzz -> Joyo Tidal Wave -> Joyo Narcissus -> Valeton GP-5.

Flamma FS-08 Octave -- bypassed

- All octave knobs (-2OCT, -OCT, +OCT, +2OCT) at 0, Dry at 100
- No octave texture anywhere in this song.

Donner Ultimate Comp -- engaged

- COMP: 40, TONE: 50, LEVEL: 55, Mode: NORMAL
- Evens out finger-attack dynamics on a part that's mostly sustained notes and simple lines -- keeps everything sitting at a consistent, controlled level across the song's big dynamic range (whisper-quiet verse to full chorus). NORMAL mode -- nothing to brighten, the B7K's own voicing is already present enough.

Donner Stylish Fuzz -- bypassed

No fuzz texture anywhere in this song.

Joyo Tidal Wave -- engaged

- Drive: 18, Blend: 25, Presence: 50, Level: 55
- Treble: 52, Middle: 55, Bass: 55

- Mid-Frequency toggle: 500Hz (body and warmth, fits the ballad better than pick-attack cut-through)
- Bass-Shift toggle: 40Hz (fuller, warmer low end -- this is a spacious ballad arrangement, not a busy mix that needs extra tightness)
- Cab-Sim (DI out): On
- Ground Lift: Off (only flip on if a specific room throws hum)
- Drive kept very light -- this pedal is doing foundational glue and a consistent DI feed only, not tone-shaping. The B7K NAM is carrying the actual tone.

Joyo Narcissus -- bypassed

Modulation is handled by the GP-5's own MOD module (B-Chorus, light, always on). Stacking this pedal on top would fight with that.

Valeton GP-5

See GP-5 settings above.

Footswitch Choreography

- **Verse:** GP-5 CTL off. Comp and Tidal Wave running underneath, unchanged.
- **Chorus:** GP-5 CTL on. Step on it going into the choir/full-band lift, off again coming back down to the next verse.